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Toronto, ON., January 9, 2003 .... Maple Leaf Foods Inc. and Canada Bread Company, Limited today announced that Canada Bread has accepted Maple Leaf Foods' financing offer to purchase four million common shares from Canada Bread at $26.50 per share in a private placement.

The financing offer was announced on December 10, 2002. The $26.50 price represented a 24% premium to the average closing price for Canada Bread common shares for the 10 days preceding the announcement and continues to represent a premium to Canada Bread's share price, which closed at $22.50 today.

The Board of Directors of Canada Bread established a Special Committee of its outside Directors to consider the financing offer. The financing offer was unanimously approved by the Board of Directors of Canada Bread based on the recommendation of the Special Committee.

The financing is expected to close before the end of January. Proceeds from the financing of $106 million will be used to pay down debt under the Company's existing credit facility.

Maple Leaf Foods Inc. is a leading Canadian food processing company committed to delivering quality food products to consumers around the world. Headquartered in Toronto, Canada, the Company employs more than 15,000 people at its operations across Canada and in the United States, Europe and Asia. Maple Leaf Foods had sales of $4.7 billion in 2001.

Canada Bread Company, Limited is a leading Canadian manufacturer of value-added flour-based products and fresh pasta to the retail and food service markets. Canada Bread maintains a national presence in the marketplace with four principal brand names: *Dempster's™, POM™, Olivieri ™* and *Tenderflake ™*

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